# Sierra Speakers Toastmasters: Macro Tutorial

A step-by-step guide for running the three automation macros in the Sierra Speakers schedule spreadsheet. Any member can use these tools. No technical background required.

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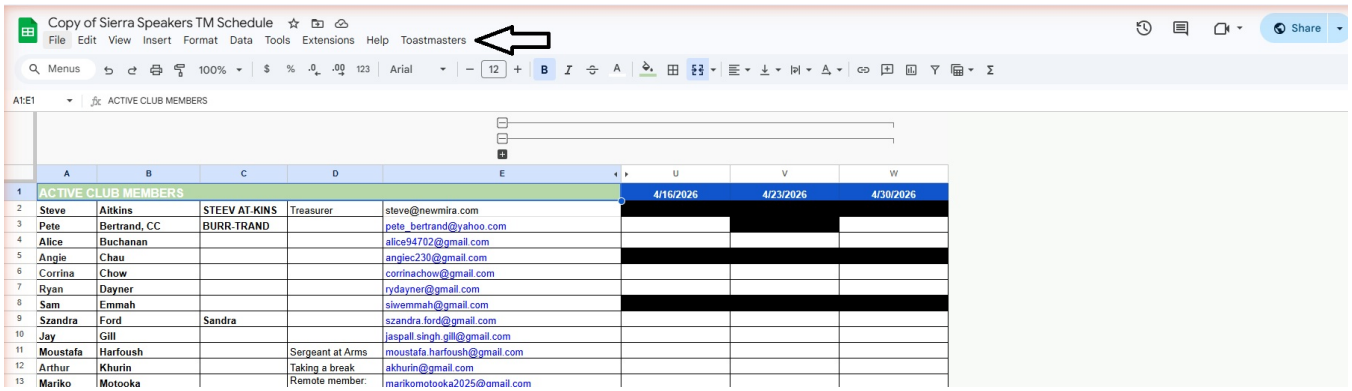
## 1. Welcome

The Sierra Speakers schedule spreadsheet includes three built-in macros that handle the most time-consuming parts of meeting prep: sending role confirmation emails, generating a formatted agenda, and drafting the weekly club email. Everything runs from a single **Toastmasters** menu inside the spreadsheet you already use.




*Sheet overview with Toastmasters menu*

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## 2. First Time Setup: Google Permissions Warning

The first time you run one of the macros, Google will show an **"This app isn't verified"** warning. This is completely normal. It appears because the script was written by your club's VP of Education, not a large software company that has paid Google for a formal verification audit.

Here is how to get past it (you only do this once):

1. When the warning appears, click **Advanced** (small link at the bottom-left).
2. Click **Go to [project name] (unsafe)**.
3. Review the permissions Google lists. The script needs access to your spreadsheet, permission to send email on your behalf, and permission to create Google Docs in your Drive. Click **Allow**.

**Why does it need these permissions?** The macros read your schedule to know who is assigned to each role, send confirmation emails from your Gmail, and create agenda documents in your Google Drive. That is all the script does. After you approve once, Google remembers your choice and you will never see the warning again.

If you are still unsure, ask a fellow member who has already approved it to walk you through the consent screen over a quick screen share.

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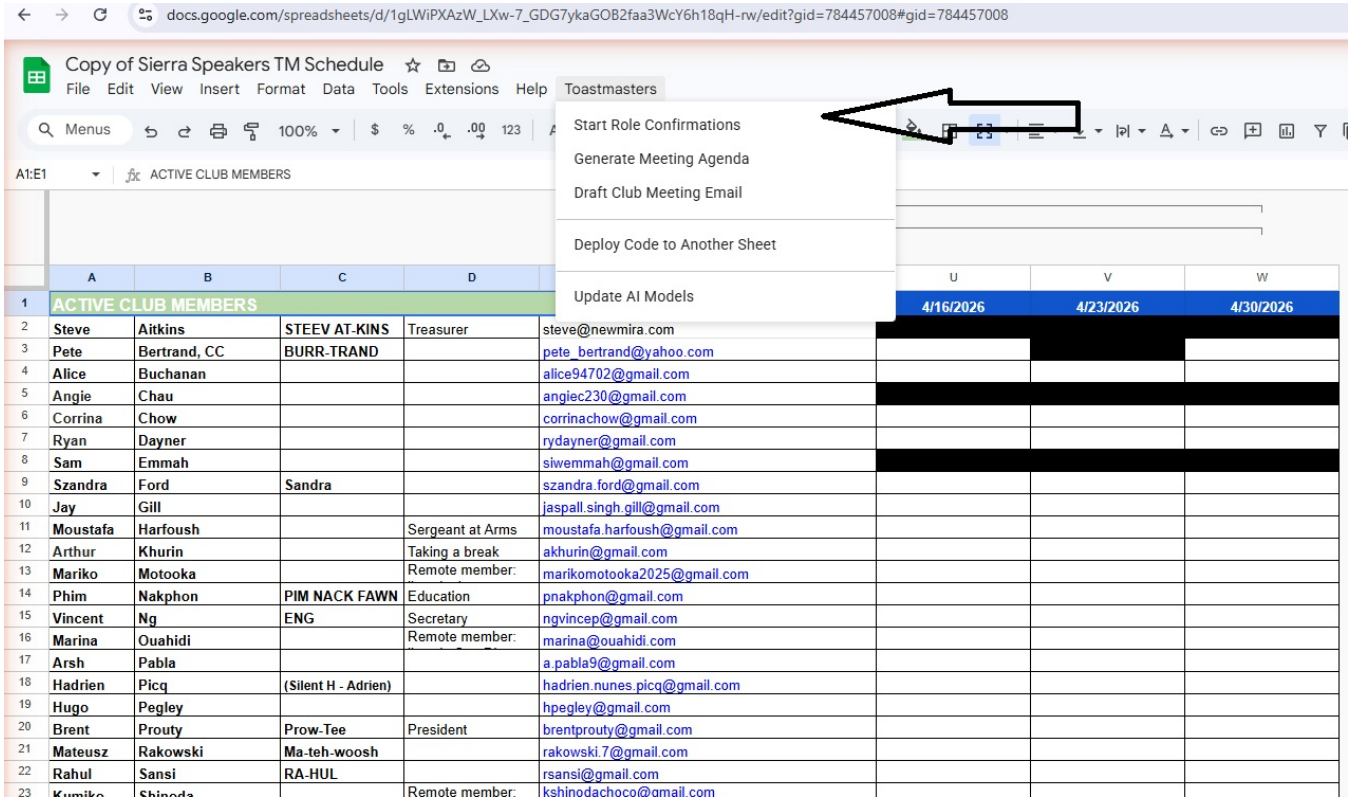
# 3. How to Send Role Confirmations

This macro emails every member assigned to a role for a specific meeting date and asks them to confirm. It also gives you a live status board showing who has confirmed, who still needs to reply, and who cannot attend.

## Step 1: Open the Toastmasters menu

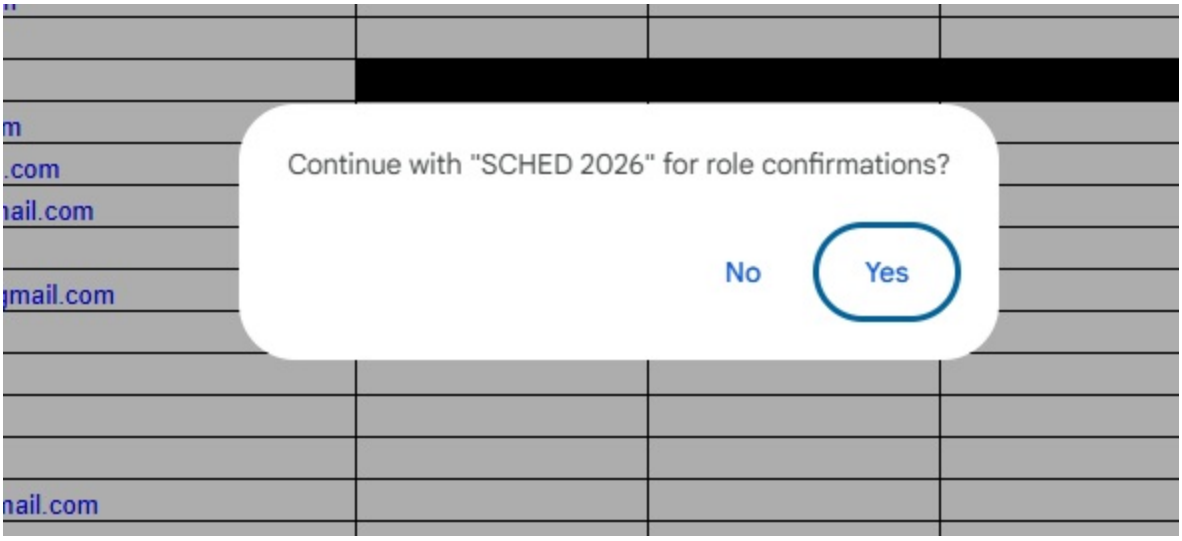
Click **Toastmasters** in the menu bar, then select **Start Role Confirmations**.




*Toastmasters menu expanded showing all items*

## Step 2: Confirm the schedule sheet

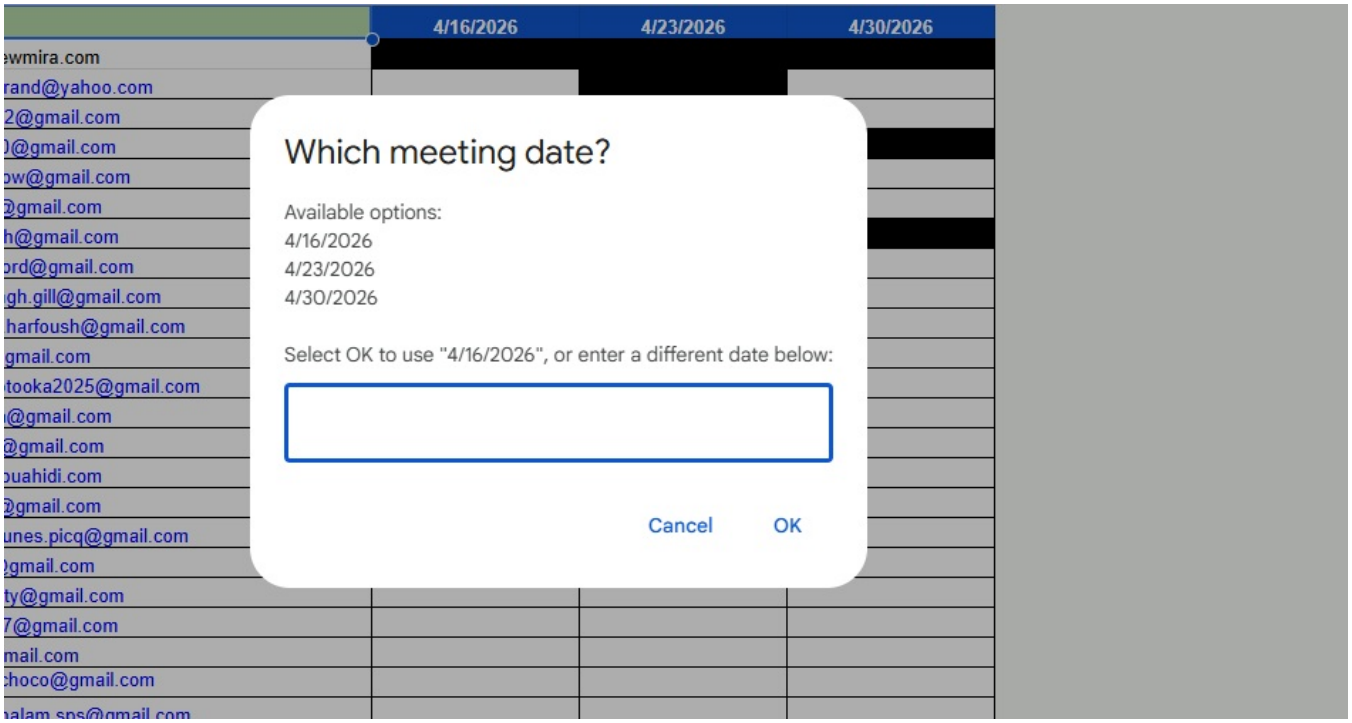
A small dialog asks whether to continue with the current schedule tab (for example, "SCHED 2026"). Click **Yes** if that is the correct schedule.




*Continue with SCHED 2026 confirmation*

## Step 3: Pick the meeting date

The next dialog lists upcoming meeting dates from your schedule. The default is the next meeting. Click **OK** to accept it, or select a different date from the list.

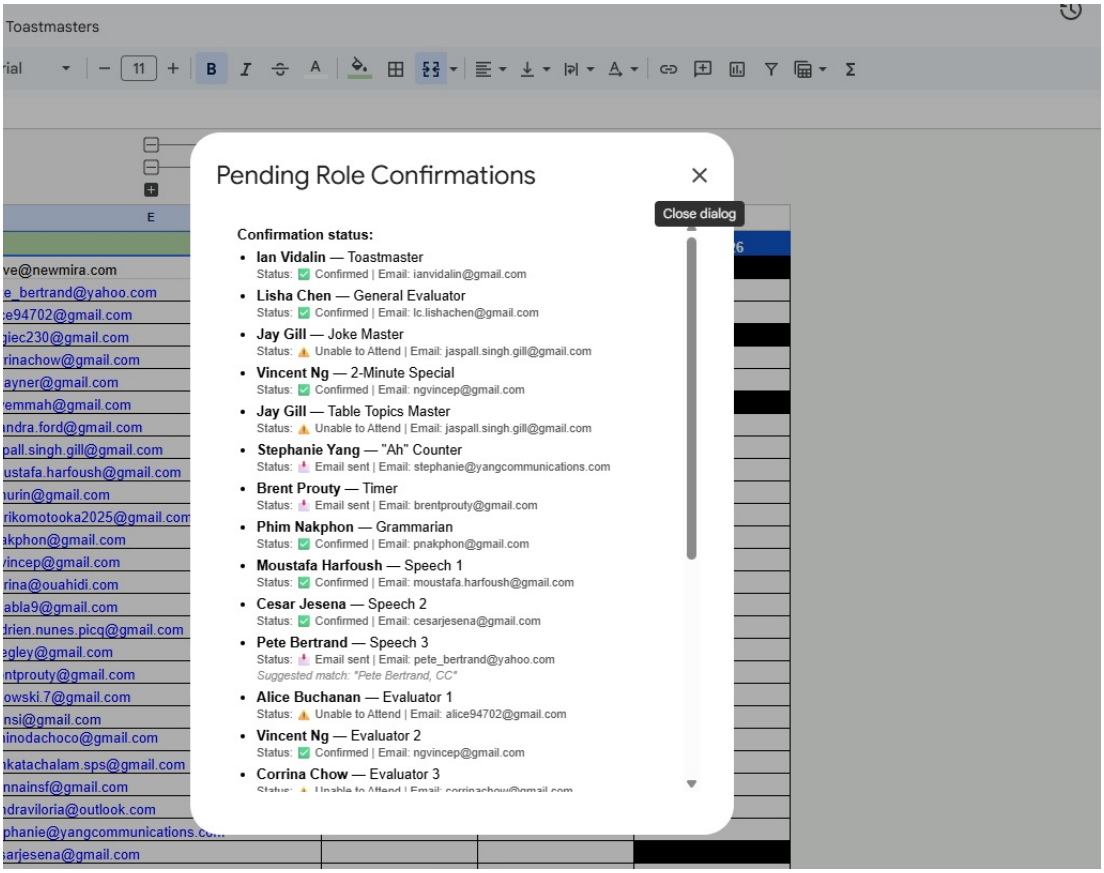



*Which meeting date dialog with available dates*

## Step 4: Review pending roles

The macro opens a **Pending Role Confirmations** panel. Each role is listed with the member's name and a color-coded status:

- **Confirmed**: the member has replied yes.
- **Email sent / Needs confirmation**: an email went out and you are waiting for a reply.
- **Unable to Attend**: the member said they cannot make it (this role needs to be reassigned).



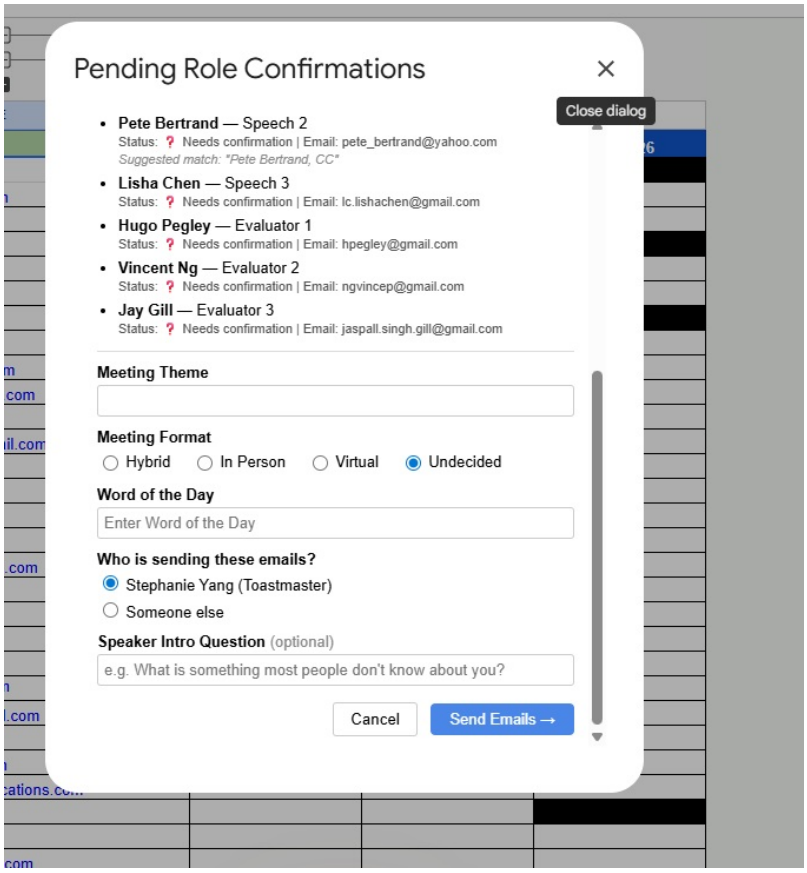
*Pending Role Confirmations panel showing role statuses*

## Step 5: Fill in meeting details

Scroll down to the bottom of the Pending Role Confirmations panel. Here you can fill in:

- **Meeting Theme**: the theme for the meeting.
- **Meeting Format**: choose Hybrid, In Person, Virtual, or Undecided.
- **Word of the Day**: enter the WOD if you have one ready.
- **Sender**: choose which member's email the confirmations come from.

When everything looks right, click **Send Emails**. The macro creates email drafts; it does **not** send anything automatically. You will find the drafts in your Gmail.



*Meeting details form with theme, format, WOD, and sender selection*

You can close the panel and re-run the macro later to refresh statuses and nudge anyone who still has not replied.

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# 4. How to Generate a Meeting Agenda

This macro builds a polished Google Doc agenda and places it in your club's Drive. It pulls the Toastmaster, speakers, evaluators, theme, and all role assignments from the schedule automatically.

## Step 1: Open the Toastmasters menu

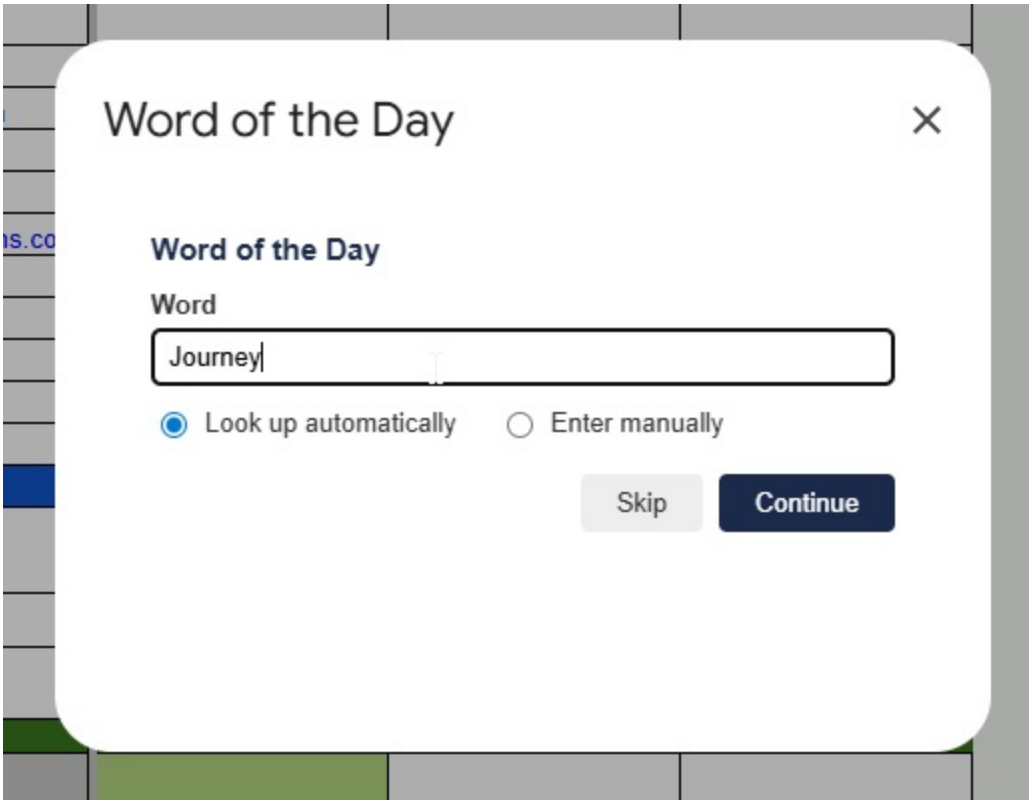
Click **Toastmasters > Generate Meeting Agenda**.

## Step 2: Pick the meeting date

The same date picker from the role confirmations flow appears. Select the meeting date and click **OK**.

## Step 3: Enter the Word of the Day

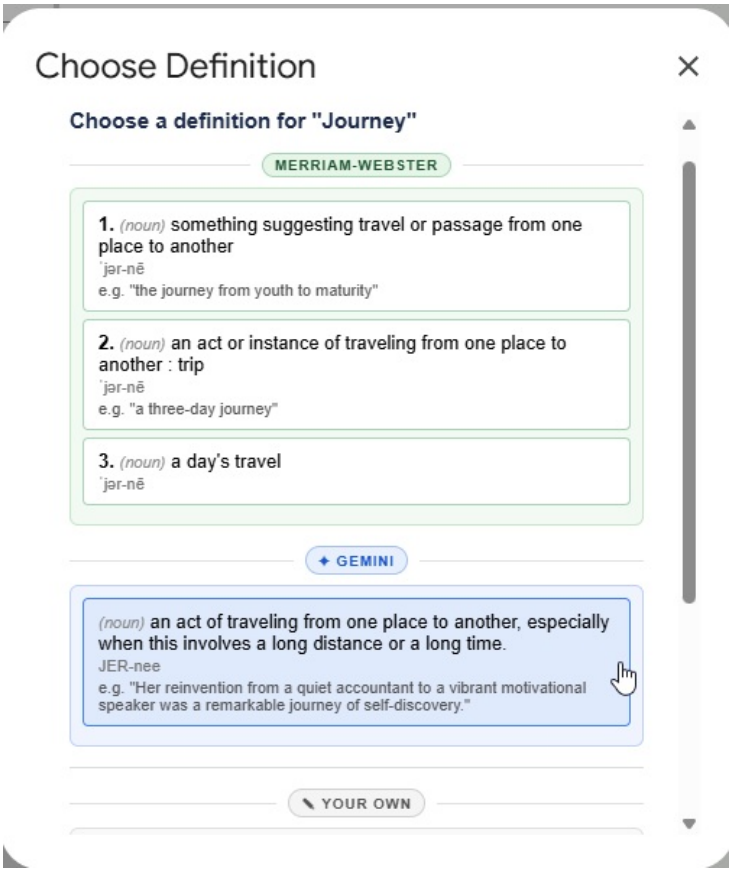
A dialog asks you to type in the Word of the Day.



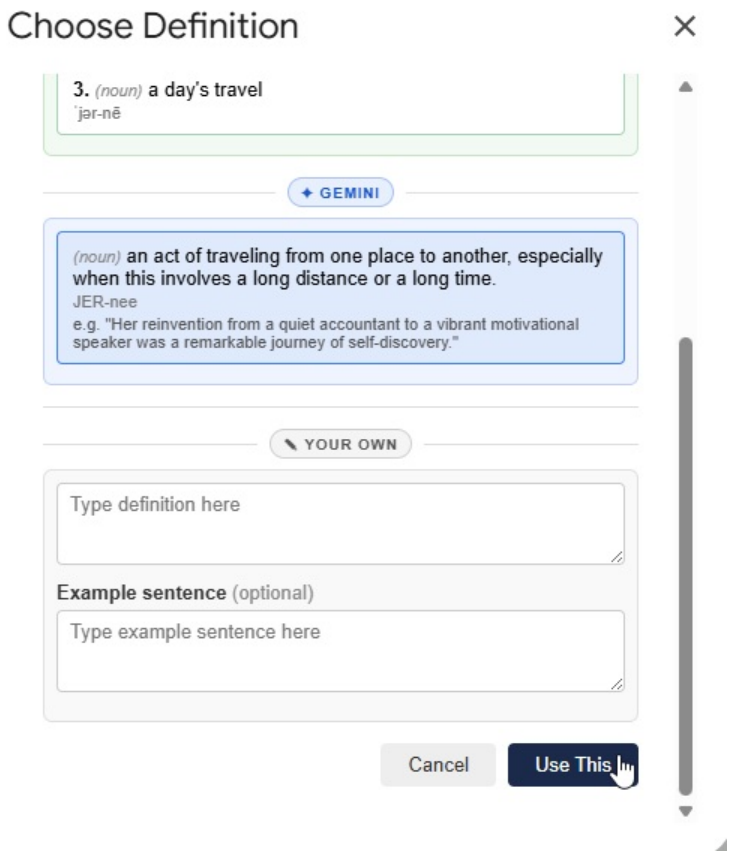
*Word of the Day text input dialog*

## Step 4: Pick a definition

The macro looks up your word and offers definition options for you to choose from. Pick the one you like best.




*WOD definition picker with options*

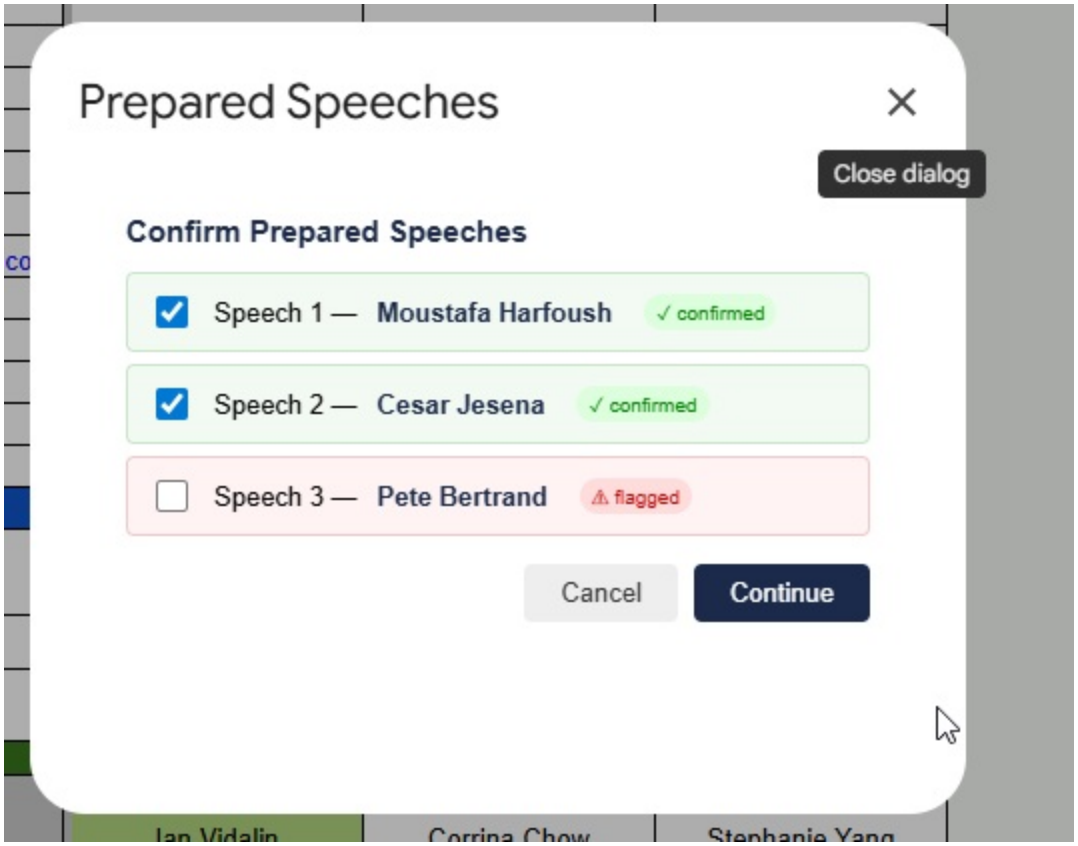



*Second WOD definition picker view*

## Step 5: Confirm prepared speeches

The macro shows the speakers it found for this meeting. Each speech is listed with its title and the speaker's name. Uncheck any speech that is not happening. Click **Continue**.

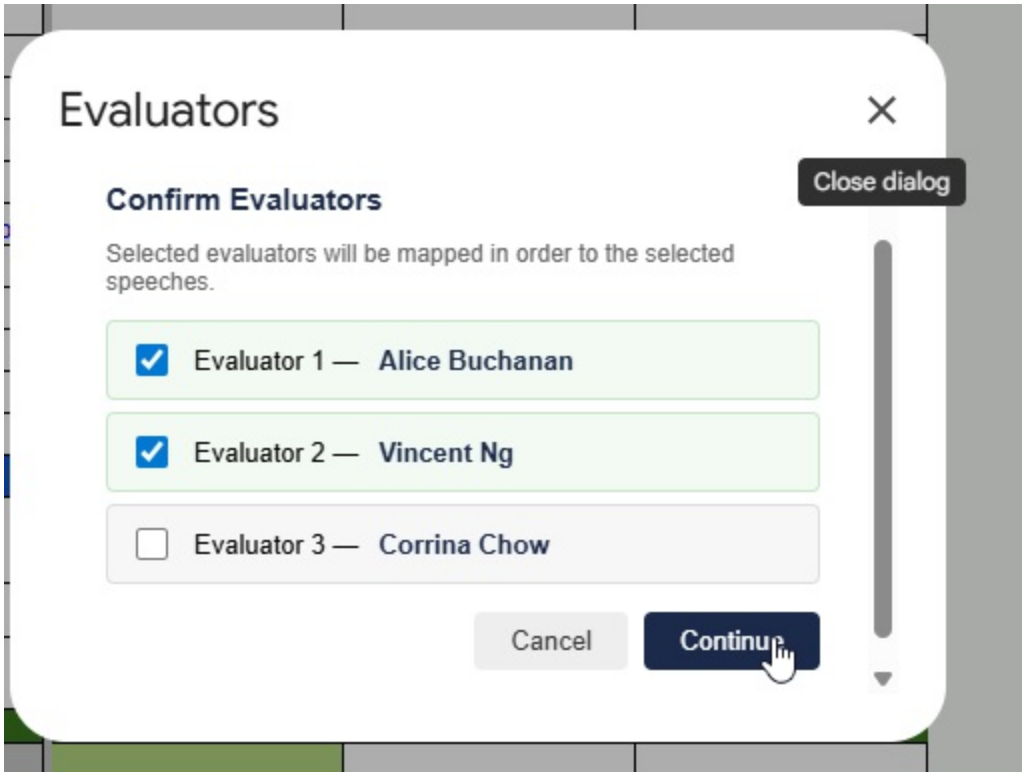
The tool can also scan your Gmail inbox for emails from speakers about their upcoming speeches. If it finds relevant messages, it will auto-populate speech titles and Pathways information for you. If nothing is found in your inbox, it falls back to whatever is already on the schedule sheet. This saves time compared to tracking down titles and pathway levels manually.



*Prepared Speeches confirmation dialog*

## Step 6: Confirm evaluators

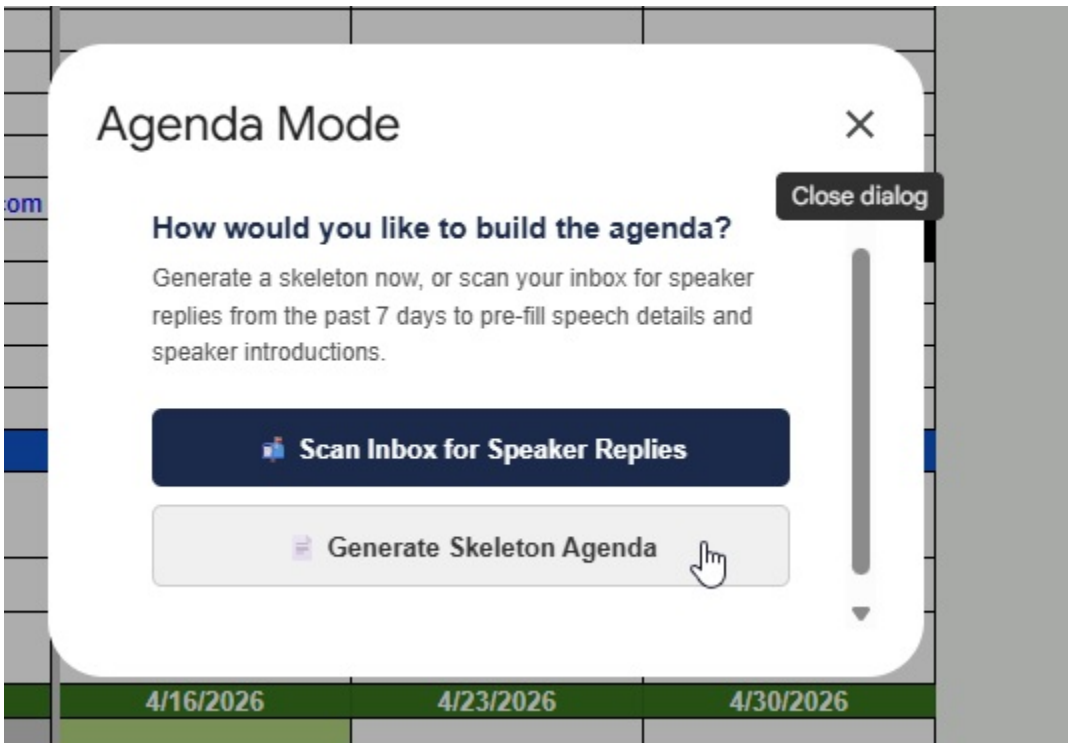
Next, confirm the evaluator assignments. The macro pairs each speaker with their assigned evaluator. Make any adjustments and click **Continue**.




*Evaluator confirmation dialog*

## Step 7: Agenda generates

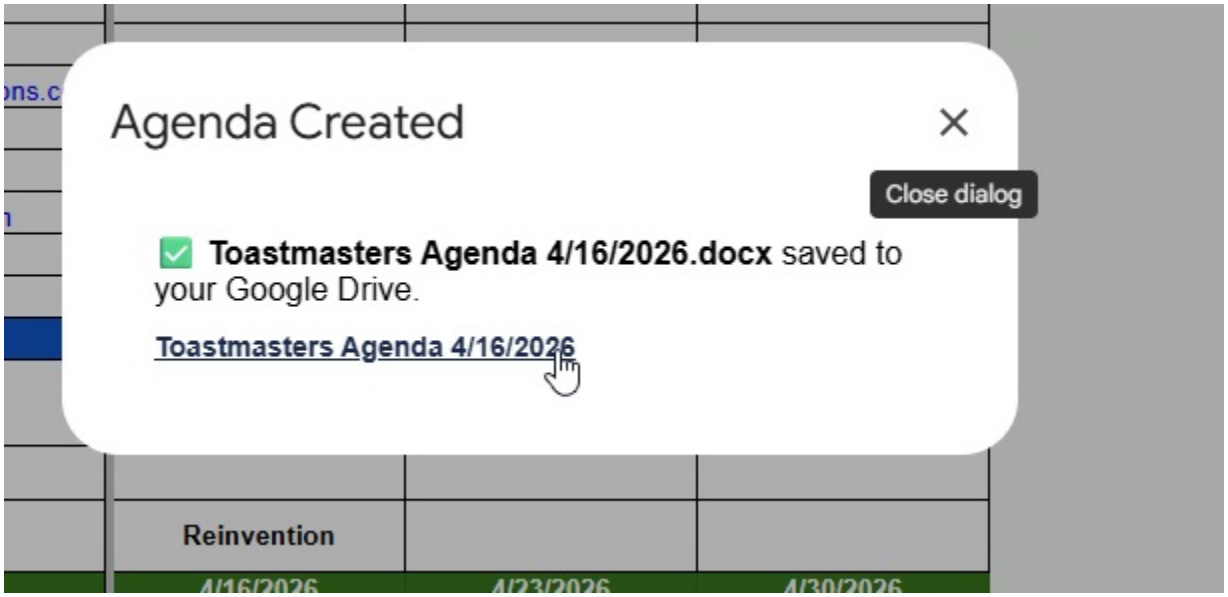
The macro builds the agenda document. You will see a progress indicator while it works.




*Agenda generation in progress*

## Step 8: Get the agenda link

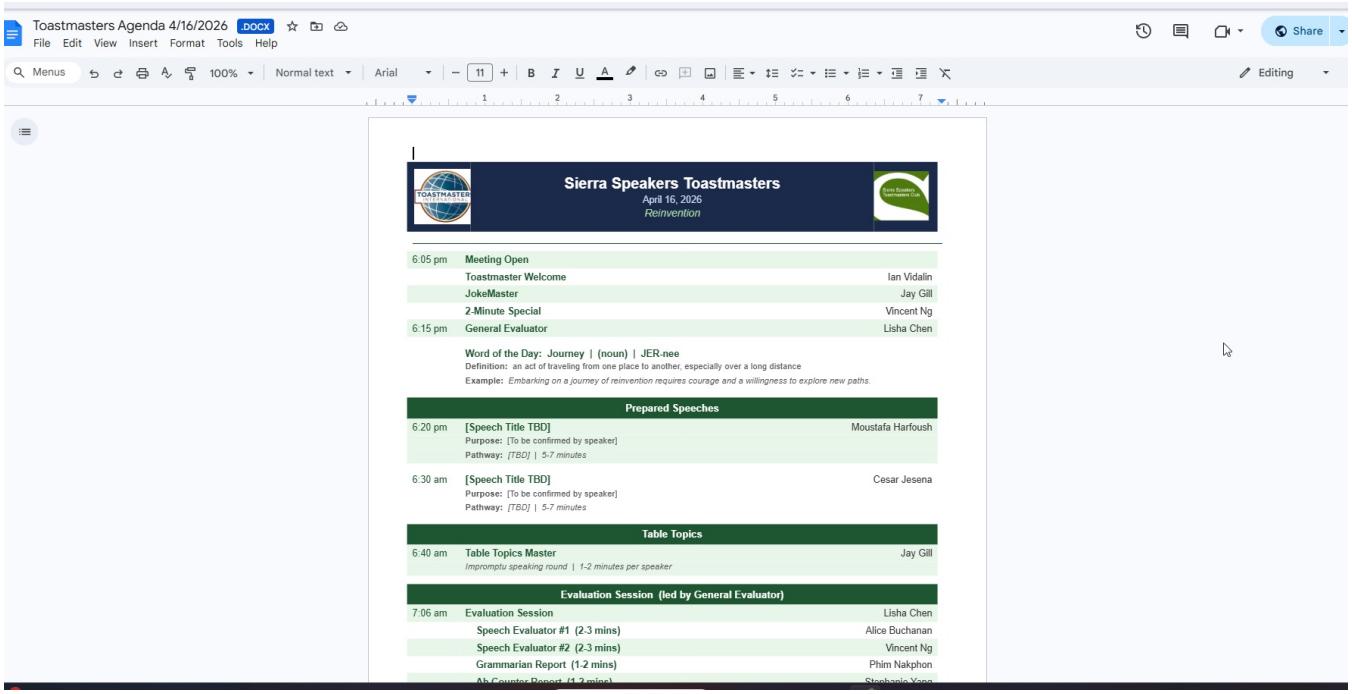
When the agenda is ready, a popup shows you the link. Click it to review your agenda. The link is automatically saved and will pre-fill in the club email dialog later.




*Agenda link popup after generation*

## Step 9: Review the finished agenda

The generated Google Doc is ready to share with your club. Open it, review the content, make any last tweaks, and share the link with your members.



*The finished Google Doc agenda*

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# 5. How to Draft the Club Meeting Email

This macro creates the weekly meeting reminder email and saves it as a Gmail draft. Nothing is sent until you open the draft and press **Send** yourself.

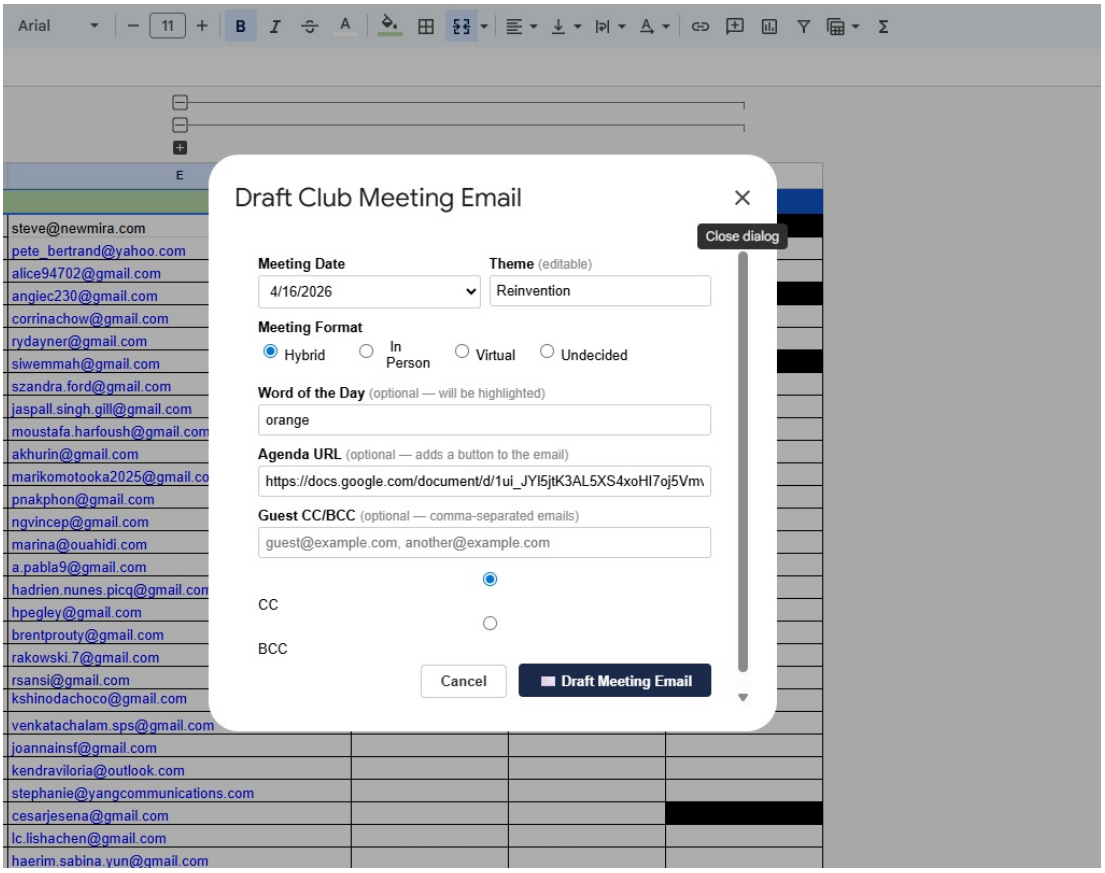
## Step 1: Open the Toastmasters menu

Click **Toastmasters > Draft Club Meeting Email**.

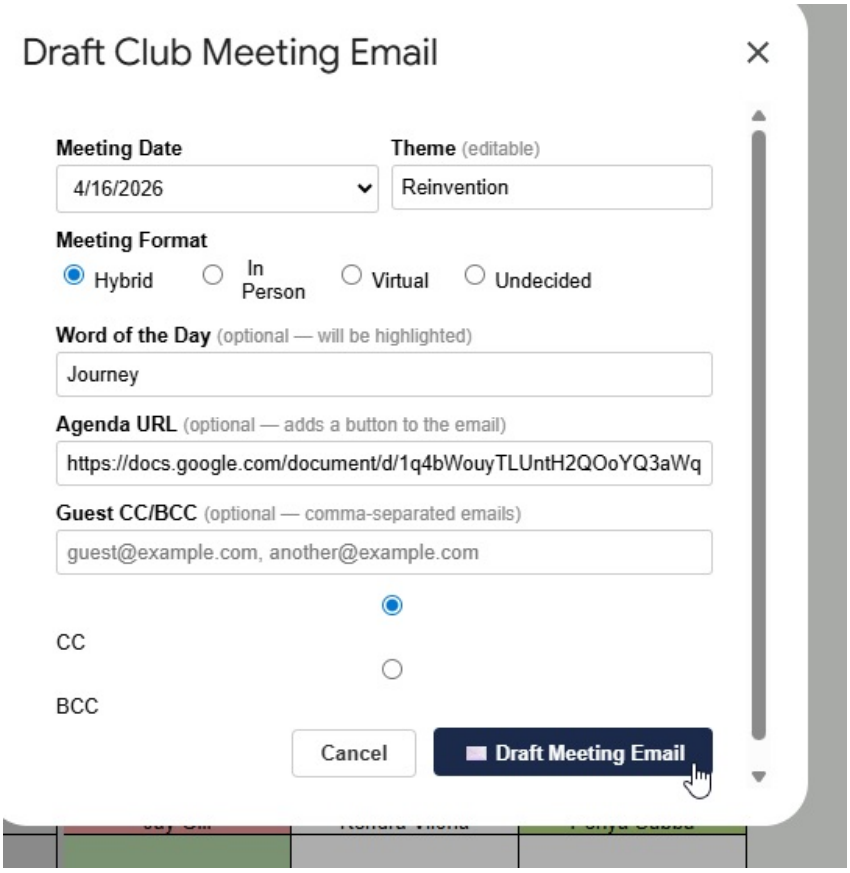
## Step 2: Fill in the email form

A dialog collects everything the email needs. Most fields come pre-populated from your earlier answers (theme, Word of the Day, agenda URL, and meeting format), so you do not need to re-enter everything from scratch. You can overwrite any field if something needs to change.

- **Meeting Format**: Hybrid, In Person, or Virtual (radio buttons at the top).
- **Theme**: the meeting theme (pre-filled if you entered one during role confirmations).
- **Word of the Day**: the WOD you used when generating the agenda (pre-filled).
- **Agenda URL**: the agenda link from the previous section (pre-filled automatically).
- **CC / BCC**: optionally add guest email addresses.



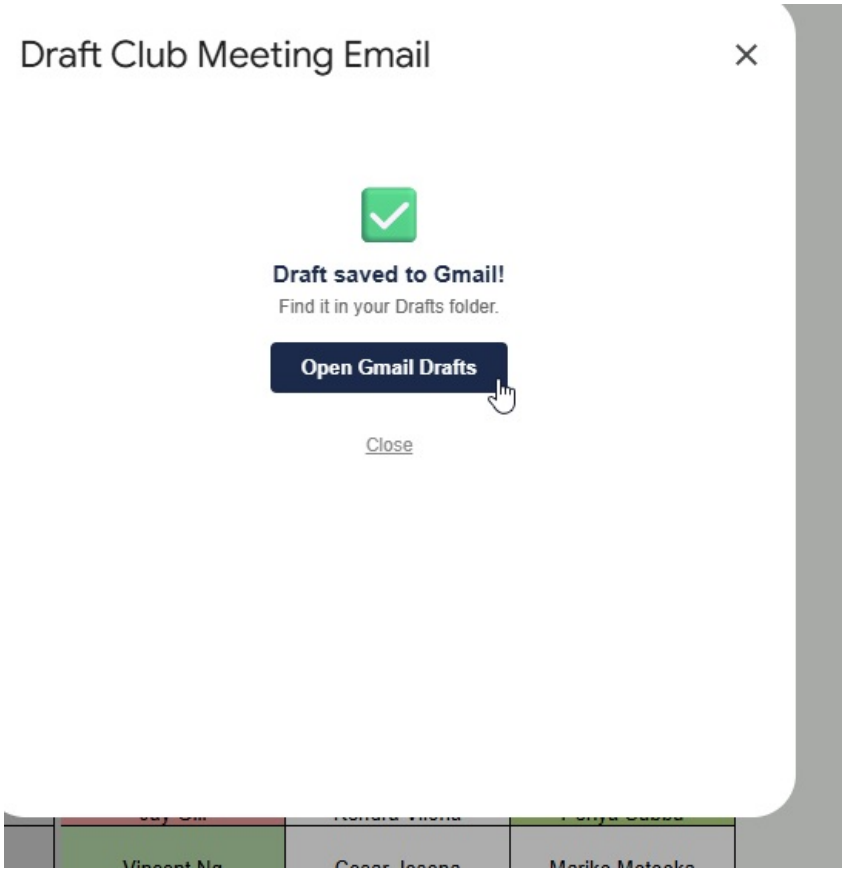

*Club email dialog overview*




*Pre-populated club email form*

## Step 3: Confirm and draft the email

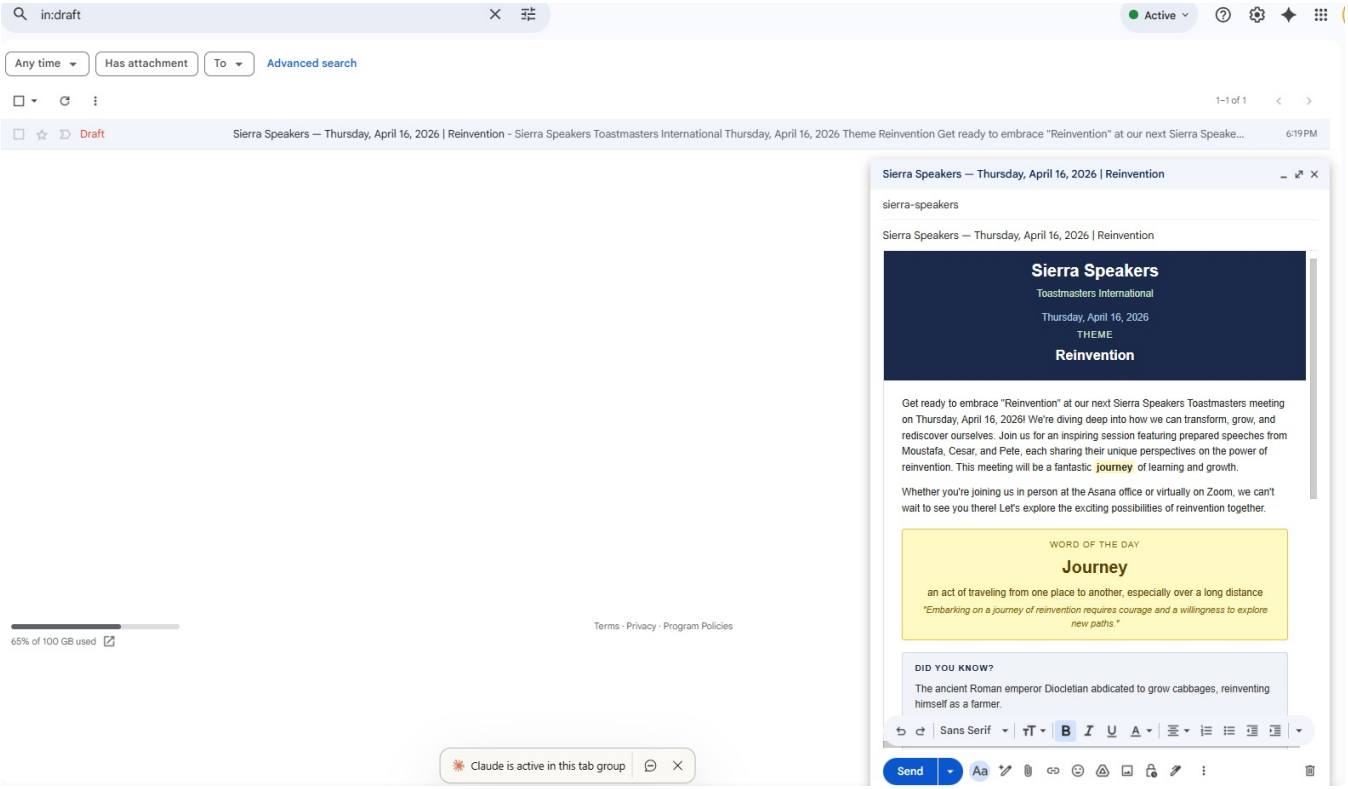
Review the form, make any changes, and click **Draft Meeting Email**. A confirmation appears when the draft has been created.



*Club email draft confirmation*

## Step 4: Review and send from Gmail

Open Gmail, find the draft under **Drafts**, read it over once, and click **Send**. This last step is always yours. The macro never sends anything on its own.




*The actual Gmail draft ready to send*

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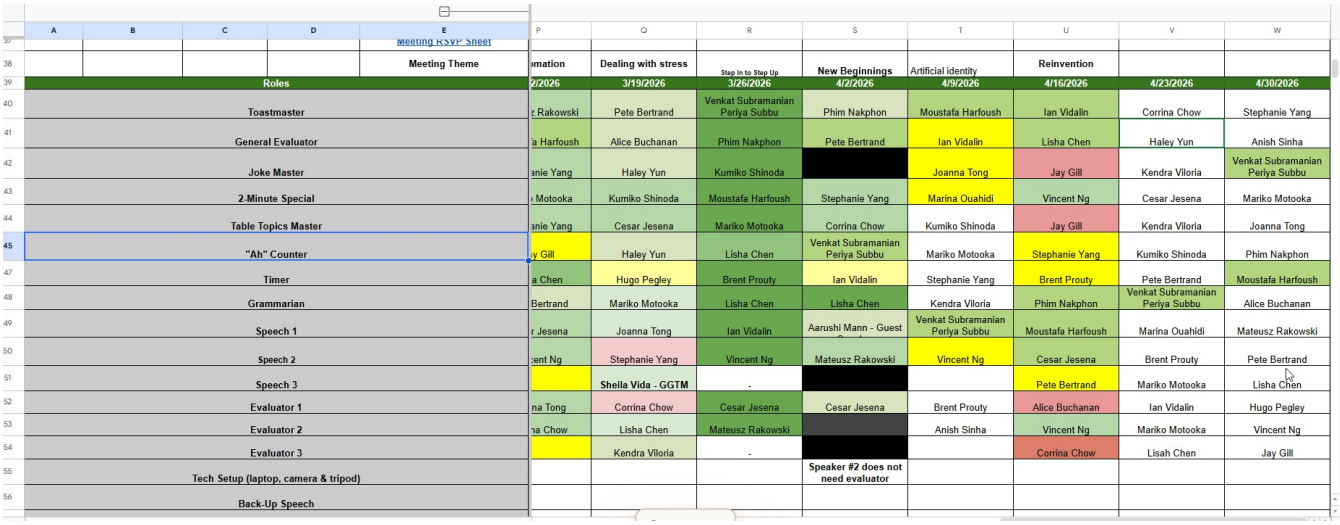
# Appendix

## A. Understanding the Color Coding

The schedule grid uses color coding so you can see the state of every role at a glance.



| Roles | Meeting Theme | Dealing with stress | Step In to Step Up | New Beginnings | Artificial identity | Reinvention | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | 2/2026 | 3/19/2026 | 3/26/2026 | 4/2/2026 | 4/9/2026 | 4/16/2026 | 4/23/2026 | 4/30/2026 |
| Toastmaster | z Rakowski | Pete Bertrand | Venkat Subramanian Periya Subbu | Phim Nakphon | Moustafa Harfoush | Ian Vidalin | Corrina Chow | Stephanie Yang |
| General Evaluator | a Harfoush | Alice Buchanan | Phim Nakphon | Pete Bertrand | Ian Vidalin | Lisha Chen | Haley Yun | Anish Sinha |
| Joke Master | anie Yang | Haley Yun | Kumiko Shinoda | | Joanna Tong | Jay Gill | Kendra Viloria | Venkat Subramanian Periya Subbu |
| 2-Minute Special | Motooka | Kumiko Shinoda | Moustafa Harfoush | Stephanie Yang | Marina Ouahidi | Vincent Ng | Cesar Jesena | Mariko Motooka |
| Table Topics Master | anie Yang | Cesar Jesena | Mariko Motooka | Corrina Chow | Kumiko Shinoda | Jay Gill | Kendra Viloria | Joanna Tong |
| "Ah" Counter | y Gill | Haley Yun | Lisha Chen | Venkat Subramanian Periya Subbu | Mariko Motooka | Stephanie Yang | Kumiko Shinoda | Phim Nakphon |
| Timer | a Chen | Hugo Pegley | Brent Prouty | Ian Vidalin | Stephanie Yang | Brent Prouty | Pete Bertrand | Moustafa Harfoush |
| Grammarian | Bertrand | Mariko Motooka | Lisha Chen | Lisha Chen | Kendra Viloria | Phim Nakphon | Venkat Subramanian Periya Subbu | Alice Buchanan |
| Speech 1 | r Jesena | Joanna Tong | Ian Vidalin | Aarushi Mann - Guest | Venkat Subramanian Periya Subbu | Moustafa Harfoush | Marina Ouahidi | Mateusz Rakowski |
| Speech 2 | ent Ng | Stephanie Yang | Vincent Ng | Mateusz Rakowski | Vincent Ng | Cesar Jesena | Brent Prouty | Pete Bertrand |
| Speech 3 | | Sheila Vida - GGTM | - | | | Pete Bertrand | Mariko Motooka | Lisha Chen |
| Evaluator 1 | na Tong | Corrina Chow | Cesar Jesena | Cesar Jesena | Brent Prouty | Alice Buchanan | Ian Vidalin | Hugo Pegley |
| Evaluator 2 | na Chow | Lisha Chen | Mateusz Rakowski | | Anish Sinha | Vincent Ng | Mariko Motooka | Vincent Ng |
| Evaluator 3 | | Kendra Viloria | - | | | Corrina Chow | Lisah Chen | Jay Gill |
| Tech Setup (laptop, camera & tripod) | | | | Speaker #2 does not need evaluator | | | | |
| Back-Up Speech | | | | | | | | |

*Schedule grid with color coding*

- **Green**: the member has confirmed their role for this meeting.
- **Red**: this role needs reassignment (the member cannot attend or has not been filled).
- **Yellow**: the member has been contacted but has not yet replied.

When you run **Start Role Confirmations**, the colors update automatically based on member responses.

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### B. Tips and Reminders

- **Always review drafts before sending.** The macros create Gmail drafts, never send directly. Take a moment to read each draft before hitting Send.
- **Run confirmations early in the week.** This gives members time to reply and lets you handle any swaps before the meeting.
- **Generate the agenda before drafting the club email.** The agenda URL will pre-fill into the email form automatically, saving you a step.
- **Re-run Role Confirmations as needed.** If someone swaps roles or a new reply comes in, run the macro again. It only emails people who have not already been contacted.
- If you see a **"Running script"** banner at the top of the spreadsheet, just wait. Google is processing the macro. Do not click anything until it finishes or a dialog appears.
- The **Toastmasters** menu only appears once the spreadsheet has fully loaded. If you do not see it right away, wait a few seconds.

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## Need Help?

Ask your VP of Education or the member who set up the spreadsheet. This tutorial and all screenshots live in the `github-repo/docs` folder alongside the rest of the Sierra Speakers materials.